



Netbooks

Brand Model	Acer Aspire One	ASUS Eee PC 904HA	ASUS Eee PC 1000H	BenQ Joybook Lite U101	Lenovo IdeaPad S10	LG X110	MSI Wind U100
Price (Rupees)	20,000	20,490	23,990	NA	24,490	26,000	25,000
Grand Total (Out of 100)	69.00	76.12	77.01	78.93	74.85	75.14	70.16
Features (Out of 70)	45.98	49.70	51.81	54.60	52.24	51.76	44.85
Performance (Out of 30)	23.02	26.42	25.20	24.33	22.61	23.38	25.31
Features and Specifications							
Processor Model No	Intel Atom N270	Intel Atom N270	Intel Atom N270	Intel Atom N270	Intel Atom N270	Intel Atom N270	Intel Atom N270
Processor Speed (MHz)	1600	1600	1600	1600	1600	1600	1600
Memory (MB) / RAM Type / Memory Speed	1 GB / DDR2 / 667	1 GB / DDR2 / 667	1 GB / DDR2 / 667	1.5 GB / DDR2 / 667	1 GB / DDR2 / 667	1 GB / DDR2 / 667	1 GB / DDR2 / 667
Chipset	Intel i945 GSE	Intel i945 GSE	Intel i945 GSE	Intel i945 GSE	Intel i945 GSE	Intel i945 GSE	Intel i945 GSE
Graphics Solution	Intel GMA 950	Intel GMA 950	Intel GMA 950	Intel GMA 950	Intel GMA 950	Intel GMA 950	Intel GMA 950
Audio Solution	Realtek ALC268	Realtek ALC662	Realtek ALC662	Realtek ALC	Realtek ALC	Realtek ALC888	Realtek ALC888
HDD Size (GB)	120	160	160	160	160	160	80
Bundled OS	XP Home	XP Home	XP Home	XP Home	XP Home	XP Home	XP Home
Characteristics							
Screen Size (Inches)	8.9	8.9	10.2	10.1	10.2	10	10
Weight (kg)	1.23	1.4	1.45	1.05	1.2	1.19	1.17
No of Ports (USB)	3	3	3	3	2	3	3
Connectivity (LAN/Bluetooth/WiFi)	✓ / ✗ / ✓	✓ / ✗ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓
Type of Memory Cards Supported	SD / MMC / MS / MSPro	SD / MMC	SD / MMC	SD / MMC / MS / MSPro	SD / MMC	SD / MMC	SD / MMC / MS / MSPro
Build Quality (Out of 10)	6.5	7	7	8	7	7	6
Ergonomics (Out of 10)	5	8	8	7	8	7	7
Performance							
Synthetic Scores							
PC Mark 2005							
CPU Score	1466	1500	1497	1497	1480	1499	1501
Memory Score	2329	2442	2430	2369	2379	2402	2397
Graphics Score	NA	NA	NA	NA	524	525	NA
HDD	4271	4360	4382	4415	4425	4772	3953
Overall	NA	NA	NA	NA	1540	1535	NA
SiSoft Sandra 2008 Lite							
CPU Arithmetic (Dhrystone / Whetstone)	4029 / 3347	4027 / 3351	4032 / 3343	4039 / 3340	4048 / 3338	4048 / 3352	4043 / 3314
CPU Multi-Media (Integer / Floating)	29469 / 19932	29437 / 19939	29342 / 19876	29449 / 19931	29503 / 19928	29562 / 20025	29277 / 20007
HDD Index / Random Access Time	51 / 9	51 / 9	54 / 9	50 / 11	53 / 9	53 / 9	39 / 14
Memory bandwidth (Integer / Floating)	2734 / 2404	3005 / 2603	2874 / 2506	2894 / 2522	2941 / 2550	2987 / 2587	2878 / 2484
3D Mark 2005							
CPU Score	252	247	241	241	NA	242	244
Overall Score	1632	1622	1589	1571	NA	1632	1635
Real World Tests							
Audio Test Speakers (Out of 10)	5	6.5	6.5	7	6.5	5	6
WinRAR 3.8 Benchmark (kB/s)	348	356	369	353	370	366	368
FarCry (fps) (640x480, low detail)	6.71	6.68	6.49	6.98	6.92	7.03	6.78
100 MB File Conversion (min:sec)	4:27	4:09	4:25	4:27	4:23	4:23	4:22
Battery Life (hrs:mins)	1:54	4:29	3:19	2:01	1:48	1:28	3:32

The MSI Wind although a decent netbook, was expensive and difficult to get in 2008. The price is still a bit on the higher side, for what it offers.

What should you get?

There was no clear winner, no netbook that stood out. All the netbooks had minor differences in the components used which reflected in the synthetic and real world benchmarks that we ran; but these performance differences were not big enough to come to notice.

Battery life was the only important performance figure that emerged from this shootout. Battery life takes on more importance, since one would typically use a netbook away from a power socket; more often than not.

As far as battery performance goes, there is nothing to beat the ASUS Eee PC 904HA. It is undoubtedly the best of the lot. Four and a half hours is a really long time for a notebook to be running on batteries. It also is good value for money and wins the Best Buy Award. The

MSI Wind U100 with its 6-cell battery is also worth considering if you want a 10-inch laptop. The ASUS Eee PC 1000H should be the next on the list.

If you just want a usable netbook at the cheapest price, then the Acer Aspire One is the king. We have learnt from the that you can buy the Windows XP version for around Rs. 17,500.

Of all the netbooks, the BenQ Joybook Lite U101 looked the best. So if you want something attention-grabbing, then this BenQ should be it. Its colourful back with its highlighted patterns will serve you nicely. It is also our Best Overall Performer with its great feature set, great speakers and build quality. ■

rossi.fernandes@thinkdigit.com & kumar.j@thinkdigit.com



Contact Sheet

Netbooks

	Contact	Phone	E-mail	Web site
Acer	Acer India	080-40708747	ganaraj.kamath@acer.co.in	www.acer.co.in
ASUS	ASUS Technology	022-67668800 / 18002090365	media.india@asus.com	www.asus.in
BenQ	BenQ India	0124-4501400	varun.singh@benq.com	www.benq.co.in
Lenovo	Lenovo India	080-22108490 / 18004252666	buy@in.lenovo.com	www.lenovo.com/in
LG	LG Electronics India	0120-2560900	salvi@lgindia.com	www.lgindia.com
MSI	MSI	18002000004	marketing@msi-in.com	www.msi-in.com